

Portfolio — Project Handoff

Owner: Ibrahim Hassan **Live site:** <https://portfolio-ih18.vercel.app> **Code:** <https://github.com/Marnie0/Portfolio> **Admin panel:** <https://portfolio-ih18.vercel.app/admin>

Read this first. Almost all your site content is now edited through the **admin panel in your browser** — not by editing code files. If you only remember one thing from this document, remember that. See section 4.

1. Project overview

What this is, in plain terms

A personal portfolio website with two halves:

1. **The public site** — what visitors see. Your name, bio, education, skills, services, projects, achievements, contact form, and a blog ("Articles").
2. **A private admin panel** — a password-protected area at `/admin` where *you* edit all of that content from a web page, on your phone or laptop, without touching code and without redeploying the site.

Content lives in a **database**, not in the code. When you change something in the admin panel, the live site picks it up **within about 60 seconds**. No deploy, no waiting, no developer needed.

The tech stack, and what each piece actually does

Piece	What it's responsible for
Next.js 15	The web framework. Builds the pages, handles routing (<code>/</code> , <code>/articles</code> , <code>/admin</code>), and runs the server code.
React 19	The UI library Next.js is built on. Components like <code>Hero</code> , <code>Projects</code> are React.
TypeScript	JavaScript with type checking. Catches mistakes (typos, wrong data shapes) <i>before</i> the site breaks.
Tailwind CSS	The styling. Colours, spacing, layout are written as class names in the markup rather than a separate CSS file.
Framer Motion	The animations — the fade-and-slide as sections scroll into view.
next-themes	Light / dark / system theme switching.
Supabase	The database <i>and</i> the login system. Stores every piece of content, plus your admin account. Also stores uploaded images.
Resend	Sends the contact-form emails to your inbox.

Piece	What it's responsible for
react-markdown	Turns the Markdown you write in articles into formatted HTML (headings, code blocks, images).
sharp	Resizes and optimises images so pages load fast.
Vercel	The hosting. Watches GitHub and rebuilds the site whenever you push.

2. How to run this locally

You need **Node.js 18 or newer** and **git** installed.

```
# 1. Get the code
git clone git@github.com:Marnie0/Portfolio.git
cd Portfolio

# 2. Install the dependencies (creates node_modules/, takes a minute)
npm install

# 3. Create your local secrets file
cp .env.example .env.local
#   then open .env.local and fill in the real values – see section 3

# 4. Start the development server
npm run dev
```

Then open **<http://localhost:3000>**.

Other useful commands:

```
npm run build    # production build – run this to check nothing is broken before pushing
npm run start    # runs the production build locally
```

Tip: don't run `npm run build` while `npm run dev` is running. They fight over the same `.next` folder and the dev server will start returning errors. Stop the dev server first (Ctrl+C), build, then start it again.

3. Environment variables

These are settings and secrets the app reads at runtime. They live in `.env.local` on your computer (never committed to git — it's gitignored) and in the **Vercel dashboard** for the live site.

Variable	Required?	Where to get it
<code>NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL</code>	Yes	Supabase → your project → Project Settings → API → <i>Project URL</i>
<code>NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY</code>	Yes	Same page → the anon / public key
<code>RESEND_API_KEY</code>	Yes for the contact form	resend.com → API Keys → create one (starts <code>re_</code>)
<code>NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL</code>	Strongly recommended	Just your live URL. Used for SEO, sitemap, link previews.
<code>CONTACT_TO_EMAIL</code>	Optional	Any email address. Overrides where contact-form mail is delivered.
<code>CONTACT_FROM_EMAIL</code>	Optional	The "from" address. Needs a domain verified in Resend.

Important things to know

- **Never put the Supabase `service_role` / secret key in this project.** Any variable starting `NEXT_PUBLIC_` is sent to every visitor's browser. The `anon` key is *designed* to be public — the database's security rules are what protect your data, not the key being hidden.
- **`NEXT_PUBLIC_*` variables are baked in when the site builds.** If you change one in Vercel, you must **redeploy** for it to take effect. Changing it alone does nothing.
- **If you ever need to regenerate a key:** create the new one in the relevant dashboard, update it in `.env.local` and in Vercel, then redeploy.

4. How to make common changes

The short version: use the admin panel

Go to <https://portfolio-ih18.vercel.app/admin>, log in with your email and password, and edit whatever you need. Changes appear on the live site within about a minute.

There is **no sign-up link anywhere** on the public site. `/admin/login` is the only login on the entire site, it isn't linked from anywhere, and public sign-ups are disabled in Supabase. It's yours alone.

Where to edit each thing

What you want to change	Where
Projects (add/edit/delete/reorder, upload cover images, featured flag)	<code>/admin/projects</code>
Skills (groups and the chips inside them) and spoken languages	<code>/admin/skills</code>

What you want to change	Where
Achievements	<code>/admin/achievements</code>
Education	<code>/admin/education</code>
Services	<code>/admin/services</code>
Hero, About and Contact text — your name, role, tagline, bio paragraphs, email, phone, WhatsApp, Telegram, button labels	<code>/admin/site</code>
About meta row (Based in / Focus / Foundation / Availability)	<code>/admin/site</code> → About meta row
Hero stats (10+ Projects, 20+ Repos)	<code>/admin/site</code> → Hero stats
Social links (GitHub, LinkedIn, Discord, YouTube...)	<code>/admin/site</code> → Social links
Articles / blog posts	<code>/admin</code> (the Articles screen)

Things every admin screen can do

- **Add** — the "New ..." button
- **Edit** — the Edit button on any row
- **Delete** — asks for confirmation first; it cannot be undone
- **Hide / Show** — removes it from the public site *without* deleting it. Useful for taking something down temporarily.
- **Reorder** — the ↑ and ↓ buttons. The order you see in the admin is the order visitors see.

List fields (skills, tech tags, deliverables, focus tags)

These are edited as **one item per line** in a text box. Blank lines are ignored. For example, a skill group's skills:

```
HTML5
CSS3
Tailwind CSS
React
Next.js
```

Safe vs. fragile files

If you *do* open the code, here's what's what:

Safety	Files	Notes
● Safe to edit	<code>lib/content.ts</code> , <code>lib/site.ts</code>	The fallback content (see below). Editing these no longer changes your live site day to day.
● Edit with care	<code>components/sections/*.tsx</code>	The visual layout of each section. Changing text here won't help — the text comes from the database. Change these only to alter <i>design</i> .
● Leave alone unless you know why	<code>middleware.ts</code> , <code>lib/supabase/*</code> , <code>app/admin/content-actions.ts</code> , <code>next.config.mjs</code>	Login protection, database access, and the security rules. Breaking these can expose your admin panel or take the site down.

What the "fallback" content is

`lib/content.ts` and `lib/site.ts` still contain a copy of your content baked into the code. It is used **only if the database is unreachable** — a Supabase outage, or missing environment variables. In that case the site keeps working and shows this older copy instead of going blank.

It does **not** activate when the database simply returns nothing. If you delete every project, the Projects section really will be empty — the fallback won't quietly bring old ones back.

Because of this, the fallback slowly goes out of date as you edit things in the admin. That's fine and expected. It's a safety net, not a second source of truth.

5. Articles (the blog)

Articles are database-only. There is no file to edit and no "coding" path. Unlike the other sections, articles have no fallback copy in the code.

To write, edit or delete an article

1. Go to `/admin` and log in
2. **New article** to write one, or **Edit** on an existing row
3. Fill in:
 - **Title** — the URL slug fills in automatically; you can override it
 - **Excerpt** — the short summary shown on the articles list
 - **Cover image** — upload from your device
 - **Content** — written in **Markdown**, with a live preview beside it (tabs on mobile)
4. **Save as draft** to keep it private, or **Publish** to make it live

Drafts are visible only to you. Visitors can't reach them even by guessing the URL — the database itself refuses to return unpublished articles.

Markdown quick reference

```
## A heading
### A smaller heading

Normal text with bold, italic, and a [link](https://example.com).

- a bullet
- another bullet

> A quoted block

`inline code`

```js
// a code block, syntax highlighted automatically
const x = 1;
```

![image description](paste-an-image-url-here)
```

Use the **Insert image** button to upload an image straight into the article — it uploads and drops the Markdown at your cursor.

Deleting

Delete from the article list. It asks for confirmation. Note that deleting an article does **not** delete images you uploaded for it — those stay in Supabase Storage. Remove them from Supabase → Storage → `article-images` if you want them gone.

6. Deployment

How it works

Your GitHub repository is connected to Vercel. **Every push to the `main` branch automatically triggers a new deployment.** You don't need to do anything else — no manual upload, no build command to run.

```
you push to GitHub → Vercel notices → builds the site → live in ~1–2 minutes
```

Checking whether a deployment worked

Easiest: go to **vercel.com**, open the project, and look at the **Deployments** tab. Each one shows *Building*, *Ready*, or *Error*.

On GitHub: the commit list shows a small ✓ or ✗ next to each commit.

If it failed: click the deployment in Vercel and read the **Build Logs**. Scroll to the **bottom** — the actual error is at the end, not the beginning.

Important: content changes don't need a deploy

Editing content in `/admin` writes to the database. The live site re-reads it within about 60 seconds. **You only need a deployment when the *code* changes.**

7. Git workflow — staying in control

Git is the version history of your code. Every commit is a save point you can return to.

Check what's going on

```
git status          # what files have I changed?
git log --oneline    # recent history, newest first
git diff            # exactly what changed, line by line
```

Save and publish your own changes

```
git add -A          # stage every change
git commit -m "Describe the change" # save it locally
git push origin main # publish → triggers a Vercel deploy
```

Undoing things

You changed a file and want to throw the change away (not committed yet):

```
git restore path/to/file.tsx # one file
git restore .                # everything – careful, this discards all uncommitted work
```

You committed something but haven't pushed yet, and want to undo it:

```
git reset --soft HEAD~1 # undoes the commit, KEEPS your changes in the files
git reset --hard HEAD~1 # undoes the commit AND throws the changes away
```

You already pushed and the live site is broken — safest fix:

```
git revert HEAD      # creates a NEW commit that undoes the last one
git push origin main
```

`git revert` is the safe option because it doesn't rewrite history. Vercel then deploys the reverted version automatically.

Instant rollback without git: in Vercel → Deployments, find the last deployment that worked, click ⋮ → **Promote to Production**. This is the fastest fix when the live site is broken.

Rule of thumb: `revert` is safe. `reset --hard` destroys work permanently. If you're unsure, use `revert`.

8. Troubleshooting

| Symptom | Check this first |
|---|---|
| Site not updating after an admin edit | Wait 60 seconds and hard-refresh (Ctrl+Shift+R). The site caches content for a minute. |
| Site not updating after a code push | Vercel → Deployments. Did the build fail? Read the bottom of the build log. |
| Contact form says it can't send | Is <code>RESEND_API_KEY</code> set in Vercel? Is the key still valid in the Resend dashboard? |
| Contact form works but no email arrives | Check spam. The default sender (<code>onboarding@resend.dev</code>) can only deliver to the address that owns the Resend account. |
| Can't log in to /admin | The password is your Supabase auth user's password — not your Supabase dashboard password. Reset it in Supabase → Authentication → Users. |
| "Server Action was not found on the server" | Your browser tab is running an old version. Hard-refresh (Ctrl+Shift+R). Harmless. |
| Uploaded image doesn't appear | Check the image is in the right Supabase Storage bucket (<code>content-images</code> or <code>article-images</code>) and that the bucket is public. |
| "column ... does not exist" | A database migration hasn't been run. The SQL files are in <code>supabase/</code> — run the missing one in Supabase → SQL Editor. |
| Site shows old content everywhere | The database may be unreachable and the site is showing its built-in fallback. Check Supabase is up and the env vars are set in Vercel. |
| Build fails with "Invalid URL" | An environment variable is set but <i>empty</i> . An empty value is not the same as unset. Either fill it in or remove it entirely. |

Where the database lives

Supabase → your project. The content tables are:

site_settings · about_facts · hero_stats · social_links · education · skill_groups ·
spoken_languages · services · projects · achievements · articles

Every table has the same security rule: **anyone can read, only your logged-in account can write**. That rule is enforced by the database itself, so even a bug in the website code can't let a visitor change your content.

The SQL used to create everything is committed in the `supabase/` folder, in numbered order, so the whole database could be rebuilt from scratch.

9. What's done vs. what's pending

Done and live

| Area | Status |
|-----------------------------------|--|
| Hero, About, Contact | ✓ Real content, editable at <code>/admin/site</code> |
| Education | ✓ 2 entries, editable |
| Skills | ✓ 6 groups + 3 languages, editable |
| Services | ✓ 6 services, editable |
| Projects | ✓ 3 real projects, editable, image upload works |
| Achievements | ✓ 3 real achievements, editable |
| Articles / blog | ✓ Fully working (public list, article pages, admin editor) |
| Contact form | ✓ Sends real email via Resend |
| Admin panel | ✓ Login-protected, covers every section |
| Light / dark / system theme | ✓ Defaults to your device setting |
| SEO metadata, sitemap, robots.txt | ✓ Live, pulls your name and role from the database |
| Deployment | ✓ Auto-deploys from GitHub |
| Photo, CV/résumé PDF | ✓ In place and linked |
| Telegram + WhatsApp buttons | ✓ Built — WhatsApp is live |

Pending / worth doing

| Item | Why it matters |
|-------------------------------------|---|
| Set your Telegram URL | <code>/admin/site</code> → Contact details. The button is hidden until you set it. |
| Check the "test" project is deleted | It's hidden from the public site, but may still exist as a hidden row. Check <code>/admin/projects</code> . |
| Write real articles | The blog works but is currently empty. |
| Custom domain | Optional. If you buy one, add it in Vercel and update <code>NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL</code> , then redeploy. |
| Verify a domain in Resend | Until then, contact emails come from a shared address and are more likely to land in spam. |
| <code>npm run lint</code> is broken | The script calls ESLint, which isn't installed. Doesn't affect the site at all — only matters if you want linting. |
| Leftover test image in storage | An unused uploaded image sits in <code>content-images</code> . Harmless; delete via Supabase → Storage if you want. |

Known quirks, by design

- **Project cover images are cropped to a 16:10 landscape band.** This keeps all cards the same height. A portrait photo will have its top and bottom cut off.
- **Deleting content doesn't delete uploaded images.** Files stay in Supabase Storage until removed manually.
- **The fallback content in `lib/content.ts` drifts out of date** as you edit via the admin. That's expected — it only appears during an outage.

Quick reference card

| | |
|---------------|--|
| Live site | <code>https://portfolio-ih18.vercel.app</code> |
| Admin panel | <code>https://portfolio-ih18.vercel.app/admin</code> |
| Code | <code>https://github.com/Marnie0/Portfolio</code> |
| Database | <code>supabase.com</code> → your project |
| Email sending | <code>resend.com</code> |
| Hosting | <code>vercel.com</code> |
| | |
| Run locally | <code>npm install && npm run dev</code> → <code>http://localhost:3000</code> |
| Check build | <code>npm run build</code> |
| Publish code | <code>git add -A && git commit -m "..." && git push origin main</code> |
| Undo a push | <code>git revert HEAD && git push origin main</code> |
| Fast rollback | Vercel → Deployments → older one → Promote to Production |